



PROGRESS REPORT

Eritrea: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 13 systems and instruments tracked

Of 13 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 3 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 2 did not, 3 carry no stated baseline, and 5 are **Not held at both ends**.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 11 sources for this place in the window — 4 in the earlier half (2025-11 to 2026-04), 7 in the later (2026-05 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Two systems entered the record for the first time in this period, with no prior position held: [ASYCUDA World](#), the customs platform inaugurated in January 2026 with a full transfer of source code to the Eritrean government, and the [Fourth Round Population and Health Survey \(EPHS 2025\)](#), the country's first digitally-collected national survey in more than a decade. A [Bank of Eritrea legal notice](#) ordering all cash deposited into banks by 31 July 2026 also entered the record with no prior position held. Mobile connectivity advanced only marginally, from 22.2% to [23.7% of the population](#). Two positions were unchanged across the window: EriTel's own reported network-expansion figures, for which the base holds only a single May 2026 snapshot with nothing to compare it against, and the UNDP grant funding Eritrea's national statistics office, active since 2019 with no new development reported. [Eri-Chat](#), the offline AI app launched in April 2025 before the window opened, was already live at the period's start and remains so.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Bank of Eritrea cash-deposit legal notice	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force; no definition given of an 'excessive amount' held outside banks, and no enforcement mechanism specified; deposit deadline 31 Jul 2026	Baseline not held

The Bank of Eritrea's cash-deposit legal notice entered the record in this window with no prior position held; the base carries no data-protection instrument at either end.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
UNDP 'Economic & Social Data Development Eritrea' grant (IATI 00099544)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Committed 2019, end year 2026 per IATI record; funds NSO statistical-capacity building, including the EPHS 2025 survey under the same D4D programme (see data.statistics)	NO CHANGE

The UNDP grant funding the National Statistics Office's data-development work is unchanged: committed in 2019 with an end year of 2026, it funded the capacity-building underlying EPHS 2025, and no new disbursement or milestone was reported in this window.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EriTel national network expansion programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	184 towers and accessories installed; landline renovation in six named towns plus the Naval Force Base; ~73km new cable laid; internet bandwidth risen to ~1,536 Mbps over the past decade; 35bn+ Nakfa cumulative investment claimed	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The base holds a single dated snapshot of EriTel's own reported network-expansion figures — [184 towers, roughly 90% geographic mobile coverage and international bandwidth risen to about 1,536 Mbps over the preceding decade, as stated by the Minister of Transportation and Communications in May 2026](#) — with no earlier figure on record to compare it against, so no movement can be stated for the programme itself. Eritrea's international-connectivity position is unchanged at both ends of the window: no submarine cable landing, and, as of July 2026, no Starlink launch date.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ASYCUDA World customs platform	2007-era paper-based customs software (no ASYCUDA)	ASYCUDA World implemented with UNDP support, full source-code transfer to the Eritrean government for national ownership	ADVANCED

ASYCUDA World advanced from a 2007-era paper-based customs system to a fully deployed digital platform, inaugurated in January 2026 with a complete transfer of source code to the Eritrean government. The Fourth Round Population and Health Survey (EPHS 2025) entered the record with no prior round held in the base for comparison: it completed in 2025 across all six regions using tablet-based interviewing, with the full report due in 2026. Neither a foundational digital-ID system nor a mobile-money or digital-payments service is held at either end of the window.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Eri-Chat offline AI app	Live since April 2025 (pre-window launch), offline open-source-AI app storing conversation data locally on-device	Live; showcased at Asmara UN Day event (24 Oct 2025) to ambassadors, UN officials and diplomats; English-only, local-language support pending (insufficient training data)	NO CHANGE

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Shambko Apps Group Tigrinya-language applications	Did not exist	Five Tigrinya-language mobile applications released by a self-organised software collective - literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools built to the national curriculum - with a stated plan to extend to Eritrea's eight other national languages; no download count, distribution channel or funding source is stated	ADVANCED

Eri-Chat, the offline AI app built by a Ministry of Information developer, was already live in April 2025, before the window opened, and its position is unchanged: it remains available, English-only, and was showcased to ambassadors and UN officials at Asmara's UN Day event in October 2025. The one thing to enter this section within the window is not a state programme: [Shambko Apps Group, a self-organised software collective, released five Tigrinya-language mobile applications](#) — literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools built to the national curriculum — with a stated intention to cover Eritrea's eight other national languages. No download count, distribution channel or funding source is stated, and the account is the state information ministry's own.

Inclusion

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Active mobile connections (DataReportal)	793,000 connections, 22.2% of population, 48.0% broadband (early 2025)	859,000 connections, 23.7% of population, 49.3% broadband (late 2025), +8.2% year on year	ADVANCED, MARGINAL

Active mobile connections advanced only marginally across the window, [from 793,000 \(22.2% of the population\) in early 2025 to 859,000 \(23.7%\) in late 2025](#) — an 8.2% year-on-year rise that leaves Eritrea among the lowest mobile-penetration rates recorded in Africa.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Fourth Round Eritrea Population and Health Survey (EPHS 2025)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Completed across all six regions using Computer-Assisted Personal Interviewing; ~400 tables across 20 chapters drafted; report writing, printing and dissemination scheduled for 2026; NSO also compiled 2023 national accounts and began 2024 national-accounts data collection	Baseline not held

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National foundational digital ID	A named programme, pilot or vendor engagement for a foundational digital-ID system distinct from the passport/civil-registration base already on file.	not yet probed
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	A licensing decision, application, or a dated update to the Submarine Networks registry's coastal-state count.	not yet probed
Starlink satellite internet service	A licence application, refusal, or an updated Starlink coverage-map entry for Eritrea.	not yet probed
Mobile money / digital payments service	A named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot, or a central-bank statement on digital payments distinct from the cash-deposit ultimatum.	not yet probed
Data-protection law	A published data-protection bill, statute or regulator designation.	not yet probed

The table above sets out what would settle each of the five absences carried through this period: a named digital-ID programme, a cable-landing decision, a Starlink licensing outcome, a named mobile-money service, and a published data-protection instrument. None was probed in this pass.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-25
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ERI/ERI-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ERI/ERI-progress-2026-08-25.pdf
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.